The tool provided by CoffeeScript for writing builds is called Cake. It's similar to the Unix utility Make and the Ruby utility Rake. It's smaller than either of those and provides fewer features. That said, Make is one of the most widely used build utilities, so if you're already familiar with it, you may prefer to use that. Either way, read on to learn how Cake works.

Imagine you agree with Scruffy to make life easier on yourselves (and anybody else who needs to build your application) by writing the build using Cake. When you have CoffeeScript installed, it's simple to get started using Cake by placing a file named Cakefile in the root directory of your project. Once you have the Cakefile, you invoke `cake` from the command line. Your Cakefile is currently empty, so the `cake` command doesn't do anything interesting:

```
> cake
```

For Cake to do something, you need to put one or more tasks in your Cakefile. In Cake, a task is a function that takes the name of the task, the description of the task, and a function that's the task itself as the three arguments:

```
task 'build', 'Compile all the CoffeeScript', ->
  console.log 'Not implemented yet'
```

Task names should contain only letters, dots, and colons. Cake doesn't currently support spaces in task names.

When you run `cake` with no arguments, it displays a list of all the tasks in the Cakefile. Right now you have only a single build task, so that's what it shows you:

```
> cake
cake build            # Compile all the CoffeeScript
```

You can run a specific task by putting the name of the task as the argument to `cake`:

```
> cake build
Not implemented yet
```